

was looking towards robots that did not need to be told what to do. Also, with Artificial intelligence research laboratories being founded at M.I.T., Stanford Research Institute (SRI), Stanford University, and the University of Edinburgh, interest in Artificial intelligence was rife around this time.

And by the end of that decade, the first mobile robot that could comprehend and reason about its surroundings was built by the Stanford Research Institute (now SRI International). The robot was named Shakey and it navigated using a combination of multiple sensor inputs, including laser rangefinders, TV cameras and “bump sensors”. In the same decade i.e. 1960, the world was introduced to ELIZA and HAL.

### A new robotic hope

Both the PUMA (Programmable Universal Manipulation Arms) and the SCARA (Selective Compliant Articulated Robot Arm) were developed and extensively used in the 1970s. In the decade of the ‘70s, manufacturing processes were increasingly incorporating robotic arms for dangerous tasks or to increase efficiency.

In this decade, Star Wars, set in a universe where humans and robots coexisted in perfect harmony, inspired many to look at the next level of human-like robots. It turned out to be something significant in the world of robotics that would inspire scientists and engineers for decades to come.



R2D2 and C3PO have sparked countless minds in the world of robotics

### From humanoid to humanlike

In 1986, Honda began a research project to develop robots that could interact with humans. Although this project would take almost a decade to bear fruit, its results would be highly significant in the coming years. Their mission goal stated that the robot “should coexist and cooperate with human beings, by doing what a person cannot do and by cultivating a new dimension in mobility to ultimately benefit society.”